

- RAG Learning

1.3 Changing Places

Geography — Eduqas A-Level (A110QS) — Component 1: Changing Places

1. The Concept of Place

Places are the central organising concept of human geography. In the Eduqas specification, a “place” is far more than its *location* — it is the intersection of physical environment, economy, society, culture and subjective meaning. Two places may share similar latitude, climate and population size yet feel radically different to an inhabitant because the *locale* (the material setting for everyday social interaction) and the *sense of place* (the emotional and symbolic meanings people attach to it) differ. Geographer John Agnew (1987) formalised this as a three-part definition: a place consists of **location** (co-ordinates on the Earth's surface), **locale** (the material setting for social relations) and **sense of place** (subjective and emotional attachment). At A-level, every place-based answer must move beyond Agnew's first element and engage explicitly with the other two.

Place: A portion of geographical space given distinctive meaning by the people who live, work, visit or imagine it. Following Agnew (1987), a place is the combination of location (absolute or relative position), locale (the built and social setting for everyday routines) and sense of place (subjective meanings, memories and emotional bonds).

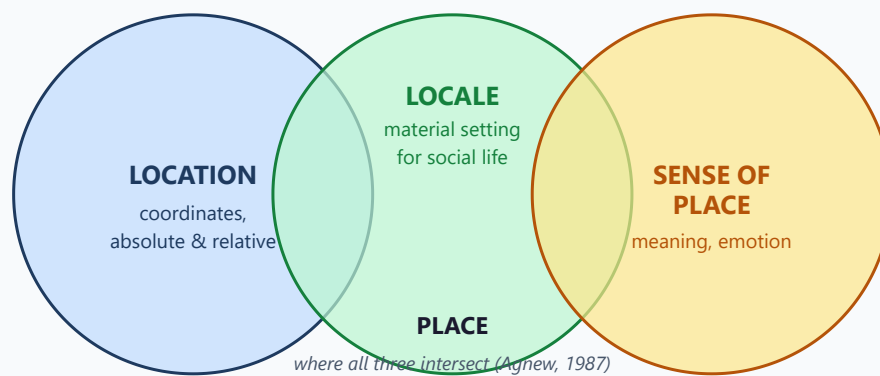
Sense of place: The subjective, emotional and symbolic attachments that individuals and groups form with a place. Sense of place is constructed through lived experience, memory, routine, cultural representation and communal storytelling, and may be positive (topophilia) or negative (topophobia).

The contemporary academic view, associated most strongly with Doreen Massey (*A Global Sense of Place*, 1991; *For Space*, 2005), rejects the idea that places are bounded, static containers with a single authentic identity. Massey's **progressive (or global) sense of place** argues that places are continually remade by

flows of people, capital, ideas, commodities and information that originate elsewhere. A place is therefore a *meeting point* of networks, not an island. This processual view matters for Eduqas because contemporary change in both Welsh rural villages and London boroughs can only be explained by flows — remittances, retirement migration, capital investment, TikTok representations — that originate far beyond the place itself.

Progressive sense of place (Massey, 1991): The view that places are porous meeting points of multiple, often global, networks rather than bounded, inward-looking containers. Place identity is always in process, relational and multiple: the “same” place simultaneously means different things to different inhabitants, visitors and diasporas.

Agnew's Three Components of Place



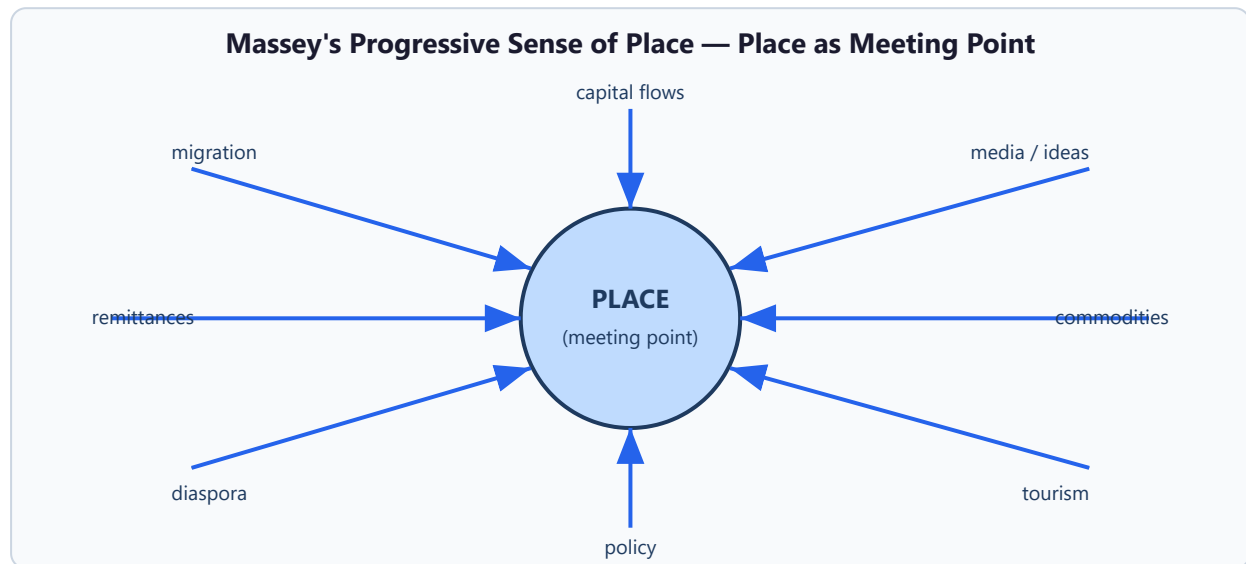
A-level answers must engage with locale & sense of place, not just location.

Exam tip — never reduce a place to its location: Top-band answers always show awareness that place = location + locale + sense of place. A question about “why has Cardiff Bay changed” that only describes the geography of the docks will cap at AO1; to access AO2/AO3 marks you must discuss how the *meaning* of Cardiff Bay (Tiger Bay identity, Welsh civic pride, post-industrial rebrand) has been contested and remade.

Massey's Progressive Sense of Place — Visualised

Massey's argument is most clearly demonstrated diagrammatically. A traditional, “bounded” view imagines a place as a line drawn around a territory, with identity derived from what is inside. Massey's view replaces

that bounded picture with an *open node* through which flows pass and in whose intersection identity is continually remade. The Kilburn High Road essay (Massey, 1991) drew this picture empirically: she observed Irish papers, Indian saris, Caribbean food shops and global finance (in the banks), arguing that Kilburn's "Kilburn-ness" consisted precisely in this stacked multiplicity of global origins, not in any single origin.



Exam tip — cite Massey explicitly: In any extended Changing Places answer, naming Doreen Massey (1991) and her "progressive sense of place" signals familiarity with the academic debate and reliably reaches AO1 top bands. Follow with one example (Kilburn High Road; Cardiff's Tiger Bay) to secure AO2.

2. Categorising Places by Experience

The specification requires candidates to distinguish between places that are experienced directly and those that are known only through mediation. These categorisations are not mutually exclusive — London is simultaneously a *near place* for its residents, a *far place* for someone in Gwynedd, and a *media place* for a viewer of British soap opera. Each label describes a relationship between subject and place rather than a fixed property of the place itself.

Near vs Far Places

- **Near place** — spatially proximate and embedded in daily routines (the home, the school, the weekly supermarket). Meanings are built up through repeated, multisensory, often unnoticed experience.

- **Far place** — spatially distant and experienced episodically or not at all. Meaning is supplied by travel, storytelling and mediated imagery. A Welsh student's sense of New York is a far-place sense of place.

Experienced vs Media Places

- **Experienced place** — first-hand, embodied knowledge (smells, sounds, weather, people).
- **Media place** — mediated by film, television, news, social media, tourist brochures or novels. The “Instagram version” of Portmeirion or the “Peaky Blinders version” of industrial Birmingham are media places that may diverge sharply from residents' experienced place.

Home as a Special Place

Home is the archetypal deeply emotional place, carrying disproportionate psychological weight. Geographers including Tuan (*Space and Place*, 1977) argue that home is where experience is densest: routines, smells, family relationships and memories accumulate in a single locale. This matters for questions about migration, displacement, regeneration-driven relocation and second-home ownership, because disruption of “home” generates emotional as well as material loss.

Topophilia (Tuan, 1974): A love of or positive emotional bond with a particular place. Its opposite, *topophobia*, describes aversion or fear. Both are meaningful geographical responses and evidence that places have affective (emotional) dimensions, not only material ones.

3. Insider and Outsider Perspectives

Every place is understood from multiple viewpoints. The simplest but most important distinction is between **insiders** — those whose identities are partly constituted by the place — and **outsiders** — those who know the place as visitors, observers or through representation. Neither perspective is more “correct”; both generate legitimate but partial knowledge.

Characteristic	Insider perspective	Outsider perspective
Knowledge source	Lived experience, routine, local networks, family memory	Visits, media, travel writing, statistics, comparison with elsewhere
Time-depth	Layered, often multi-generational	Snapshot; recent and episodic

Sensory range	Full multisensory — weather, smells, sounds, language, community	Visual and narrative dominated; filtered through mediation
Language	Uses local dialect/place names; bilingual in Welsh-speaking communities	Standardised, national or tourist English; may mispronounce
Strength	Depth, nuance, understanding of contradiction	Comparative perspective, fresh observation, critical distance
Weakness	Parochialism; may naturalise inequality or decline	Superficiality; stereotyping; “othering” of residents

Insider / outsider: Contrasting positions from which a place is experienced and represented. Insiders derive understanding from embodied, everyday, often long-term participation in the place; outsiders derive it from episodic visits and mediated representations. Contestation arises when outsider narratives come to dominate decision-making and override insider experience.

Contestation arises when outsider representations dominate local narratives. In Welsh rural villages, tourist-board imagery of pristine “unspoilt” countryside elides the lived reality of post-office closures, depopulation and language decline; in London's East End, “Cool Britannia” branding of Shoreditch erased Bengali and Jewish histories of the same streets. Good A-level answers always ask: *whose* story of the place is being told, and *whose* is being silenced?

Exam tip — name the perspective you are using: When evaluating change, state explicitly whether you are reporting an insider or outsider view, or contrasting the two. Examiners consistently reward answers that handle the same place from multiple positionalities (e.g. “to original Docklands residents the LDDC was dispossession; to financial workers it was regeneration”) rather than a single neutral description.

4. Endogenous and Exogenous Factors

Place character emerges from the interaction of **endogenous factors** (those originating within the place) and **exogenous factors** (those originating outside it). Eduqas examiners expect both to be identified and

weighed. Contemporary scholarship (and contemporary change) increasingly privileges the exogenous: few places in the 2020s can be explained without reference to global capital, migration and media.

Endogenous factors: Internal characteristics that shape a place's identity — physical geography (topography, geology, climate, drainage), demographics (age structure, ethnicity, gender balance), economy (employment sectors, key industries), built environment (architecture, density, street plan), heritage and land use. These give a place its “raw material” for identity.

Exogenous factors: External flows and forces shaping a place — migration, investment (FDI), tourism, media representation, trade connections, government policy and globalisation. Exogenous factors determine how the raw material of endogenous character is reinterpreted, valorised or disrupted over time.

Endogenous factors (internal)	Exogenous factors (external)
Topography, geology, climate, drainage	Migration flows (international, internal, return)
Demographic structure (age, ethnicity, gender)	Foreign direct investment, venture capital, REITs
Employment & industrial mix	Tourism and second-home ownership
Built environment, street pattern, density	Media representation (film, news, social media)
Heritage and historical land use	Trade connections and supply chains
Local governance & community organisations	Central/devolved government policy
Vernacular architecture, language, dialect	Globalisation and time-space compression

Exam tip — weigh, don't list: Low-scoring answers list endogenous and exogenous factors as two parallel columns. High-scoring answers *weigh* them: for post-1981 London Docklands, exogenous factors (Thatcher's UDC policy, global finance relocation, the Big Bang deregulation of 1986) were decisive; endogenous factors (the riverside location, the brownfield infrastructure) were enabling conditions, not drivers.

5. Globalisation and the Reshaping of Places

Globalisation — the deepening interconnection of places through flows of goods, capital, people, ideas and images — is the dominant exogenous force acting on 21st-century places. David Harvey's concept of **time-space compression** (*The Condition of Postmodernity*, 1989) describes how telecommunications and cheaper transport have collapsed the experienced distance between places, so that a Welsh village is only a click away from a Sydney suburb. This does not homogenise places, but it does change the scale at which place identity is negotiated.

Time-space compression (Harvey, 1989): The apparent shrinking of the world as transport and communication technologies reduce the time cost of moving information, goods and people between distant places. Effectively expands each place's functional reach while making distant places more present in daily life.

Glocalisation: The adaptation of global products, practices or brands to local tastes and cultures (e.g. McDonald's selling the vegetarian McAloo Tikki burger in India; Starbucks operating as a traditional *kissaten*-style space in Kyoto). Places negotiate rather than passively receive global flows.

Clone town: A settlement whose high street has lost its independent, locally distinctive retailers and is dominated by nationally or globally branded chains, producing a homogenised streetscape (New Economics Foundation, 2004). Often cited as evidence of placelessness produced by globalisation.

Placelessness (Relph, 1976): The loss of distinctive local character in a place through standardised design, chain retail and mass-produced architecture. Edward Relph argued that modern motorway services, airports and suburban retail parks exemplify “placeless geography” — interchangeable locations that could be anywhere.

Counter-movements resist homogenisation by re-asserting local distinctiveness: the **Transition Towns** movement (launched in Totnes, Devon, 2006) networks communities designing local resilience in food, energy and economy; the **Slow Food** movement (Italy, 1986) defends regional cuisines; localism policies in the *Localism Act 2011* gave English communities limited powers to list Assets of Community Value. In Wales, the Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 embeds sustainable place-making as a statutory public-body duty.

Exam tip — pair globalisation with a counter-movement: When asked to assess the impact of globalisation on place, always pair a homogenising force (clone towns, chain retail) with a counter-force (Transition Towns, farmers' markets, localism, Welsh-language planning requirements). Top-band answers show that globalisation provokes resistance and adaptation, not simply erasure.

Placelessness, Clone Towns and Distinctiveness

The New Economics Foundation's 2004 and 2010 *Clone Town Britain* audits scored British high streets on independent retailer diversity. Cambridge scored 9 (most cloned); Whitstable scored 65 (most distinctive). The 2010 report found 41% of UK towns were “clone towns” against 25% “home towns”. The methodology has been critiqued (sample bias, retail-only focus) but the concept remains influential. Placelessness is driven by: retail consolidation (8 supermarket chains account for over 90% of UK grocery spend), corporate property ownership concentration (large institutional landlords), planning homogenisation (out-of-town retail parks, standardised design codes) and national-scale consumer preference formation via advertising.

Counter-forces include: Business Improvement Districts (BIDs) with local distinctiveness mandates; heritage listing and conservation areas (the UK has ~9,000 conservation areas); local design codes in Neighbourhood Plans; independent retailer support schemes such as Totally Locally (launched Calderdale, 2010) and the Plunkett Foundation's village shop revival. In Wales, the Welsh Retail Consortium's “Shop Local” and bilingual-branding initiatives link distinctiveness explicitly to linguistic identity.

6. Place Meaning and Representation

A place is represented — and therefore in part constituted — through multiple media. Eduqas requires candidates to recognise the range and limitations of these representations and to compare quantitative and qualitative data about the same place.

Types of Representation

- **Media representations** — films, television, news, advertising, video games. Doctor Who's Cardiff “standing in for” 21st-century futures altered external perception of the city during the 2005–present reboot.
- **Literary and artistic place** — Dylan Thomas's *Under Milk Wood* (1954) turned “Llareggub” (a thinly disguised Laugharne) into an icon of Welsh coastal identity; L.S. Lowry's matchstick figures over smoke-stacked mills became the visual shorthand for the industrial North of England (Salford, 1930s–60s).

- **Photographic and digital** — curated Instagram geotagging has produced “honeypot” over-tourism at sites like Trefor Sea Stacks (Llyn Peninsula) and the Fairy Pools of Skye.
- **Statistical representation** — the UK census (England/Wales every 10 years, last 2021; Scotland 2022), ONS sub-regional data, the English and Welsh Indices of Multiple Deprivation (WIMD 2019). Quantitative, comparable, but blind to meaning.
- **Qualitative representation** — interviews, oral history, ethnography, place-mapping. Captures meaning but resists standardisation and generalisation.

Literary and Artistic Place — Extended Analysis

Dylan Thomas's Swansea and Laugharne — Thomas (1914–53) mythologised his home places in both poetry (“Do not go gentle into that good night”, 1947) and prose (*Portrait of the Artist as a Young Dog*, 1940; *Under Milk Wood*, 1954). His representation of coastal Wales as lyrical, close-knit, mildly absurd and emotionally dense has shaped the external image of West Wales for decades; the Dylan Thomas Centre in Swansea and the Boathouse in Laugharne are now tourist-board anchors. Yet Thomas's Swansea also records bombing during the *Three Nights' Blitz* (February 1941), when over 800 high-explosive bombs destroyed much of the town centre — a place-identity moment invisible to purely touristic representations.

L.S. Lowry's industrial North — Lowry (1887–1976) painted Pendlebury, Salford and Manchester's mill districts over a 50-year career (“Coming from the Mill”, 1930; “Industrial Landscape”, 1955). The “matchstick figures” visual shorthand for industrial Lancashire has proved remarkably durable: The Lowry arts centre (opened 2000 at Salford Quays) was central to the regeneration of the former Manchester Docks, and the paintings' image of a now-vanished industrial North is simultaneously a record and a romanticisation. For Eduqas, Lowry illustrates how artistic representation lingers in collective place memory long after the material place has transformed.

Other examples worth naming: Kazuo Ishiguro's English country house and West Country road-trip in *The Remains of the Day*; Kate Roberts's Welsh-language novels of Caernarfonshire quarry villages; Danny Boyle's *Slumdog Millionaire* (2008) as a mediated Mumbai; the Arctic Monkeys' early lyrics as a representation of 2000s Sheffield nightlife.

Contested Place Narratives

Place names themselves are sites of contested representation. In April 2023 the Brecon Beacons National Park Authority formally adopted the Welsh name **Bannau Brycheiniog** and dropped the “beacons” branding, linking the re-naming to decolonisation of landscape and opposition to the fossil-fuel imagery of beacons. Critics read the change as politicised erasure; supporters read it as reclamation of indigenous

Welsh place identity. Similar contests surround colonial-era street names, toppled statues (Colston, Bristol, 2020), and the listing of sites of slavery-linked heritage.

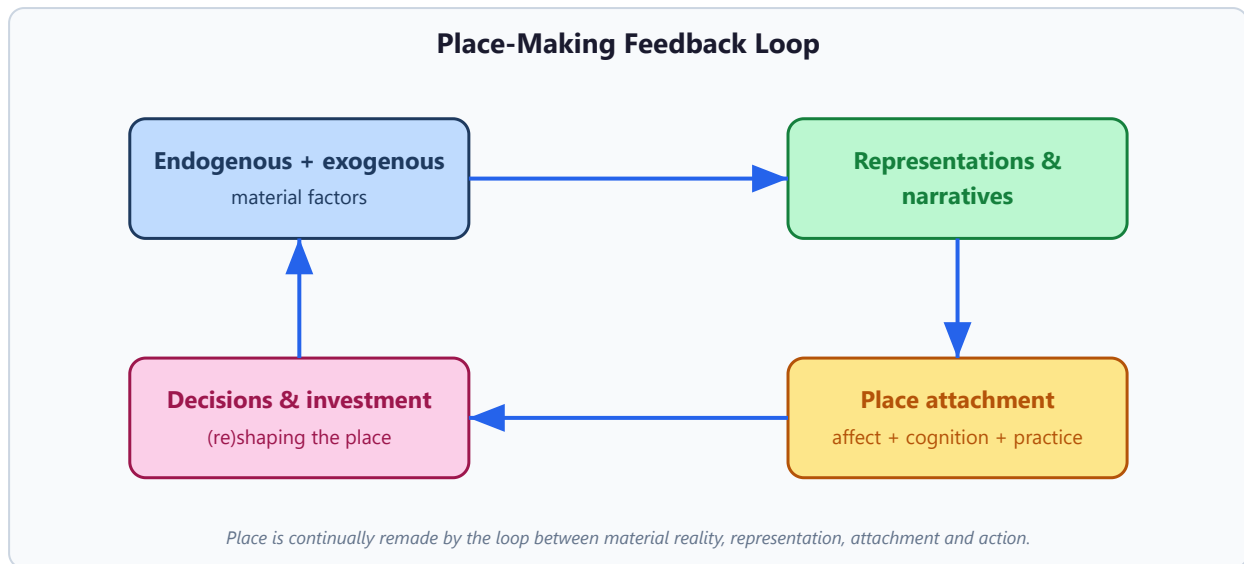
Exam tip — triangulate representations: Eduqas 15-mark evaluations on place representation reward triangulation: quantitative data (census), qualitative source (interview, novel, photograph) and contested narrative (policy dispute, renaming, heritage debate). Do not rely on a single source type.

Exam tip — use a well-known contested case: Place-representation answers benefit from one detailed contested example: Bannau Brycheiniog renaming (2023), bilingual signage policies under the Welsh Language Measure 2011, Dylan Thomas's Swansea, or Cardiff Bay vs Tiger Bay contested naming all work well alongside your own home place.

7. Place-Making and Place Attachment

Place-making is the deliberate or emergent shaping of a place's identity through design, practice and storytelling. Low and Altman (1992) proposed a three-component model of **place attachment** comprising *affect* (feeling), *cognition* (knowledge and memory) and *practice* (embodied routine). All three are required: reciting facts about a place without feeling or practice is not attachment; visiting without learning its history is shallow attachment.

Place attachment (Low & Altman, 1992): The emotional bond between a person or group and a place, composed of three interacting elements: *affect* (positive or negative emotional response), *cognition* (knowledge, memory, meaning ascribed to the place) and *practice* (routine embodied activity within the place). All three must be present for strong attachment.



Place-based identity is both personal (“I am a Swansea boy”) and collective (shared history, communal events, distinctive landscape features). Community festivals (Eisteddfodau, Notting Hill Carnival, local food festivals), vernacular buildings, protected views and named landscape features (Pen y Fan, Cadair Idris) are reservoirs for collective attachment. When these are threatened — by demolition, renaming, privatisation or inappropriate development — the affective response is disproportionate to the material loss because identity itself feels threatened.

8. Processes of Place Change

Eduqas requires confident handling of six interlocking processes that reshape places. Candidates should be able to define each, give a UK example and weigh winners against losers.

Deindustrialisation

The decline of manufacturing employment, absolute or relative, in a place. In the UK, manufacturing's share of employment fell from ~30% in 1970 to ~8% by 2020. Places with concentrated heavy industry (South Wales valleys, Teesside, the Black Country, west-central Scotland, Detroit) suffered the sharpest effects: mass unemployment, out-migration of the young, dereliction, negative place image and compounding deprivation. The Welsh coal industry employed 271,000 men in 1920; by 2008, when Tower Colliery closed, deep-mining employment had collapsed to almost nothing.

Economic restructuring — the Clark–Fisher model: as economies develop, employment shifts from the primary sector (farming, mining, fishing) to the secondary sector (manufacturing) and then to the tertiary (services) and quaternary (knowledge, research, ICT) sectors; over 80% of UK jobs are now in services.

Drivers include new technology and automation, changing lifestyles, government strategy and globalisation, which moved manufacturing to lower-cost economies. The loss of traditional industry can trap places in a *cycle of deprivation*: unemployment → lower incomes and spending → business closures and a shrinking tax base → poorer services, out-migration of young and skilled people and a negative image that deters investment → further decline (though lower industrial pollution is a benefit).

The service and knowledge economies: retail and leisure change has reshaped central areas — out-of-town retail and office parks (e.g. Meadowhall, Sheffield; Cribbs Causeway, Bristol) and internet shopping (roughly a quarter of UK retail sales by the mid-2020s) have left vacant units on many high streets, while food, leisure, night-time economies and re-urbanisation revive others. The *quaternary* knowledge economy clusters near universities and research institutes, good infrastructure, government support and flexible planning — e.g. the Cambridge cluster (“Silicon Fen”), Tech City around Shoreditch in London, MediaCityUK in Salford and Cardiff’s compound-semiconductor cluster. Clusters bring well-paid jobs, place-marketing and global connectivity, but also house-price inflation, congestion and a widening gap between knowledge workers and others.

Gentrification

Coined by sociologist Ruth Glass (1964) in relation to Islington, gentrification describes the movement of higher-income residents into a formerly working-class or low-income area, leading to rising property values, physical upgrading and displacement of the original community. Contemporary British examples include Hackney, Peckham, Dalston, Digbeth and Cardiff’s Canton.

Gentrification (Glass, 1964): A process of neighbourhood change in which wealthier residents progressively replace lower-income residents in a formerly working-class area, accompanied by housing upgrading, rising rents, changing retail mix and displacement. Often celebrated for physical “improvement” and criticised for dispossession of original communities.

“Push” factors for gentrification	“Pull” factors for gentrification
Rising city-centre rents push professionals outward	Cheaper property in working-class areas close to centre
Suburban saturation & commute fatigue	Distinctive architecture (Georgian/Victorian stock)
Lifestyle preference for urban amenities	Public-transport links & regeneration investment

"Back-to-the-city" cultural narratives in media	Emerging "authentic" food/cultural scene
Weakening of social-housing stock	Student population attracting speculative landlords

Counter-urbanisation

The movement of people from cities to smaller towns and rural areas, producing population growth in places previously losing people. In England and Wales ONS data show net intra-UK migration out of London to the regions exceeded 100,000 per year in 2020 and 2021, accelerated by Covid-19 and remote-working. Counter-urbanisation reshapes rural places — house prices rise, young locals are priced out, second-home ownership increases, and the character of "host" villages changes.

Counter-urbanisation: The movement of population and economic activity from major cities to smaller urban and rural settlements. Drivers include rising urban costs, lifestyle preferences, improvements in transport and, in the 2020s, the shift to remote and hybrid work.

Re-urbanisation

The opposite, overlapping flow: the return of population, investment and leisure to city centres, often after decades of decline. City-centre populations in Birmingham and Manchester have grown several-fold since 2001 (Census data). Drivers include flagship regeneration, student accommodation, waterfront leisure, and cultural investment. Re-urbanisation frequently triggers gentrification.

Regeneration

The planned physical, economic and social renewal of a place, typically combining built-environment investment with cultural, economic and community programmes. UK regeneration has passed through distinct phases: the *Urban Development Corporation* model (1981–98, e.g. LDDC, Cardiff Bay Development Corporation); *City Challenge* and the Single Regeneration Budget (1990s); the *New Labour* neighbourhood renewal framework (2001–10); and contemporary devolved initiatives (Welsh Government's Transforming Towns programme 2020–, UK Levelling Up Fund 2021–).

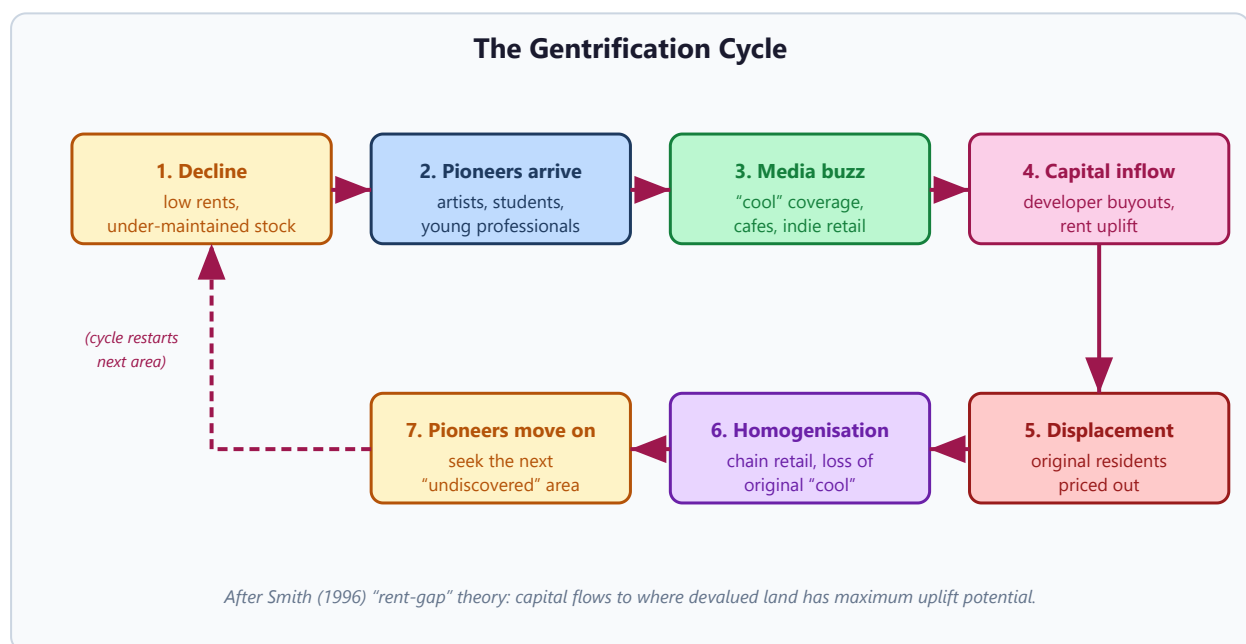
Regeneration: Coordinated intervention to reverse the physical, economic and social decline of a place. Encompasses demolition, new construction, infrastructure, employment programmes,

education investment and place-marketing. Usually requires flagship projects to anchor the wider programme.

Rebranding

A communicative process: the deliberate use of marketing, design and events to project a new identity for a place. Rebranding often accompanies regeneration but can occur without physical change (e.g. "Hull — UK City of Culture 2017"). Effective rebranding requires coordination between place-managers (local authorities, BIDs, DMOs), media and residents; lazy rebranding imposes an outsider narrative and is rejected.

Rebranding: The intentional use of marketing, design, events and storytelling to change the perception of a place, usually to attract investment, tourism or residents. Distinct from physical regeneration but frequently paired with it.



Exam tip — distinguish regeneration from rebranding: Regeneration reshapes the material fabric; rebranding reshapes the meaning. Many places undergo both simultaneously but they are analytically separate. Identify which predominates in any case study you name — Hull 2017 was predominantly rebranding; London Docklands was predominantly regeneration with heavy rebranding as flagship.

9. Required Case Studies

Eduqas requires at least two local places compared at different scales plus reference to a wider context. The four case studies below cover the expected range: an urban regeneration flagship, a rural Welsh community under exogenous pressure, a contrasting Welsh urban regeneration scheme, and an international comparator of deindustrialisation and attempted recovery.

Case study 1 — London Docklands regeneration (1981–present):

Context: The East End docks (London Docks, West India Docks, Royal Docks, Isle of Dogs) handled the bulk of imperial trade until containerisation shifted shipping to Tilbury and Felixstowe in the 1960s–70s. By 1980 the area had lost 150,000 jobs, contained 20 km² of dereliction, and housed a deprived, predominantly white working-class community with emerging Bangladeshi settlement in Tower Hamlets.

Intervention: The **London Docklands Development Corporation (LDDC)** was established under the Local Government, Planning and Land Act 1980 (operating 1981–98), with powers to override local authorities, compulsorily purchase land and grant planning permission. An Enterprise Zone (1982–92) on the Isle of Dogs offered capital-allowance tax breaks.

Flagship elements: **1 Canada Square** (800 ft, 1991, then the UK's tallest building), **Canary Wharf** estate (Olympia & York / Brookfield), the **Docklands Light Railway** (opened 1987), London City Airport (1987), Jubilee Line Extension (1999), and most recently the Elizabeth line (Crossrail, 2022) with Canary Wharf station. By 1998 about £1.9 billion of public money had levered roughly £7.7 billion of private investment, and investment has continued since.

Outcomes — positives: employment in the LDDC area rose from ~27,000 (1981) to ~85,000 by 1998, and Canary Wharf alone now has over 100,000 workers (most in banking and professional services); population rose from ~39,000 (1981) to ~83,000 by 1998 and has kept growing; major transport infrastructure; a global financial centre rivalling the City of London; new residential capacity for inner-London professionals.

Outcomes — negatives: Original East End communities saw limited benefit — LDDC by-passed borough councils, only ~25% of new jobs went to local residents at first, and rapid house-price inflation displaced renters. The *Docklands Consultative Committee* (community-led, 1985) documented sustained grievance. Environmental costs included heavy traffic, loss of dock heritage, and “island effect” separating Canary Wharf from surrounding deprived wards (Tower Hamlets

remained among the most deprived local authorities in England on the Index of Multiple Deprivation into the 2020s).

Legacy: Contested. Insiders (long-term East Enders) frequently frame it as dispossession; outsiders (financial workers, tourists) as flagship success. Iconic in the UK UDC model and studied worldwide.

Case study 2 — Gwynedd: Welsh rural villages under second-home and language pressure:

Context: Gwynedd contains the highest proportion of Welsh-speakers of any UK local-authority area (64.4% Welsh-speakers, 2021 Census — down from 65.4% in 2011) and some of the UK's most visited national landscapes (Eryri/Snowdonia, Llŷn Peninsula, Anglesey). Villages such as **Abersoch**, **Morfa Nefyn** and **Aberdaron** have experienced rapid growth in second-home and holiday-let ownership since the 1990s. Abersoch at peak saw over 40% of dwellings classed as second homes; in some Gwynedd census wards the proportion exceeds 30%.

Exogenous pressures: Counter-urbanisation from NW England, retirement migration, Airbnb-driven short-let boom (2015–present), media representation of the coast as “Welsh Riviera”. House prices in Gwynedd rose ~35% 2020–2023 while median Welsh earnings rose ~15%, widening the affordability gap for young locals.

Endogenous response: **Gwynedd Council** raised the council-tax premium on second homes from 50% (pre-2017) to 100% (2020) and then up to **150% from April 2023**, with powers to charge up to 300% under revised Welsh Government rules. A statutory planning Article 4 direction was introduced requiring planning permission for a main residence to be converted to a holiday let. The *Cymdeithas yr Iaith Gymraeg* (Welsh Language Society) has campaigned on property and language links under the slogan *Nid yw Cymru ar Werth* (“Wales is not for sale”).

Community buybacks: Welsh communities have used community share issues and Community Asset Transfer to secure local assets — e.g. Tafarn y Plu in Llanystumdwy (Gwynedd), bought by villagers in 2012; in Blaenau Ffestiniog the *Cwmni Bro Ffestiniog* network of community enterprises runs shops, housing and tourism businesses.

Welsh Government policy: Under the Cooperation Agreement (2021–24) between Welsh Government and Plaid Cymru, a three-pronged strategy was introduced: council-tax premium changes, statutory registration of short-term lets, and a new planning use class for second homes and holiday lets (in force 2022–23).

Insider/outsider tension: To outsiders the villages are picturesque holiday destinations; to insiders they are Welsh-language communities being hollowed out of year-round residents, school rolls and local services. This is a near-textbook Eduqas example of contested place meaning.

Case study 3 — Cardiff Bay regeneration (contrasting Welsh urban flagship):

Context: Before 1987 the Cardiff docks area, known as **Tiger Bay**, was one of the UK's oldest multi-ethnic communities (Somali, Yemeni, West African, Caribbean, Irish, Welsh) built around the 19th-century coal-export docks. By the 1980s coal exports had collapsed, the docks were derelict and the community was stigmatised in external representations (news, crime fiction).

Intervention: The **Cardiff Bay Development Corporation (CBDC)**, 1987–2000, modelled on the LDDC, directed £2.4 billion of investment into a 1,100-ha regeneration area. Its signature project was the **Cardiff Bay Barrage** (opened 1999), which dammed the tidal Taff/Ely estuary to create a 200-ha freshwater lagoon and an eight-mile waterfront.

Flagship elements: **Mermaid Quay** leisure development, **Wales Millennium Centre** (opened 2004, arts venue and bilingual Welsh national stage), **Senedd Cymru** (Welsh Parliament building, opened 2006, architect Richard Rogers), Roald Dahl Plass public square, the Doctor Who Experience (2012–17), the Ice Arena, and extensive private apartment schemes.

Outcomes — positives: Over 16,000 jobs created; 6,000+ new dwellings; significant domestic and international tourism; Welsh devolution given a visible civic home; Cardiff's place-brand transformed from “post-industrial coal port” to “European capital city”.

Outcomes — negatives: Displacement of original Tiger Bay residents through CPO and rent inflation; loss of vernacular docklands architecture; the barrage altered the intertidal SSSI and the estuarine mudflats that had supported internationally important wader populations (RSPB legal action, 1990s); concerns that “Cardiff Bay” branding erased the older “Tiger Bay” multi-ethnic identity. Community group **Butetown History & Arts Centre** has documented the contested narrative.

Comparison with London Docklands: Similar institutional model (UDC), similar flagship approach, similar tension between outsider-led investment and insider-held history. Cardiff Bay differs in hosting devolved national institutions, explicitly bilingual signage, and a deliberately civic (not purely commercial) flagship mix.

Case study 4 — Detroit, Michigan (international comparator of deindustrialisation):

Context: Detroit was the fifth-largest US city in 1950 with a peak population of **1,849,568**, built around the Ford, GM and Chrysler motor industry (the “Big Three”). Foreign competition (Japanese imports from the 1970s), automation, suburbanisation (the 1956 Interstate Highway Act), white flight after the 1967 riots and the 2008 financial crisis combined to produce one of the most dramatic population collapses in modern history: **639,111 residents in the 2020 Census**, a 65.4% decline. Census Bureau estimates then showed the first population growth for decades in 2023 and 2024 (~646,000 by 2024).

Crisis: In **July 2013** Detroit filed the largest municipal bankruptcy in US history, with ~\$18–20 billion of liabilities. Over 80,000 buildings were abandoned; up to 40 km² of the city were effectively vacant. Unemployment, school closure and violent crime rates were among the worst in US urban statistics.

Regeneration experiments: **Detroit Future City** strategic framework (2012) proposed “right-sizing” the city — consolidating services in viable neighbourhoods and converting depopulated land to productive green use. The **Dan Gilbert / Rocket Mortgage / Bedrock** investment portfolio bought and restored over 100 downtown buildings from 2011 onwards, relocating 17,000+ employees to downtown. **Urban agriculture** initiatives (Hantz Woodlands — a 140-acre urban tree farm; Keep Growing Detroit — 1,500+ community gardens) repurposed vacant lots. The Q Line streetcar (opened 2017) and the Little Caesars Arena (2017) anchor downtown rebranding.

Outcomes: Downtown and Midtown Detroit have recovered substantially (rising property values, new residents, restaurants), but the effect is highly uneven — most neighbourhoods beyond the 7.2 sq miles of “Greater Downtown” have continued to lose population. Critics argue this is gentrification of an enclave, not recovery of the city.

Comparative relevance for Eduqas: Detroit shows (a) the scale of deindustrialisation effects, (b) the limits of flagship and private-capital led regeneration when the underlying economic base has collapsed, and (c) how rebranding (“Detroit Hustles Harder”) functions alongside material change. A strong international contrast with UK regeneration programmes where devolved and UK-state funding play a larger role.

Case Study Comparison Matrix

Dimension	London Docklands	Gwynedd villages	Cardiff Bay	Detroit
Dominant process	Regeneration + re-urbanisation	Counter-urbanisation + second-home pressure	Regeneration + rebranding	Deindustrialisation + partial regen
Scale	Major global city district	Small rural settlements	Devolved capital waterfront	Major US metropolis
Lead agency	LDDC (UDC, UK state)	Gwynedd Council + Welsh Gov't	CBDC (UDC, UK + Welsh)	Municipal + private capital
Key flagship	Canary Wharf / DLR	Council-tax premium & use-class	Senedd / Barrage	Downtown Bedrock portfolio
Winners	Financial workers, developers	Young locals (policy-willing)	Tourists, devolved institutions	Downtown residents, investors
Losers	Original East End residents	Welsh-language community fabric	Tiger Bay community, estuary SSSI	Non-downtown neighbourhoods
Welsh-context link	UK-scale comparator for CBDC	Welsh rural contrast	Welsh urban contrast	International contrast

Exam tip — quote quantified facts per case study: Strong candidates can deploy three to four numbers per case study under exam pressure: for London Docklands — jobs ~27,000 → ~85,000 (1981–98), LDDC 1981–98, 1 Canada Square 800 ft 1991; for Detroit — 1.85m (1950), 639k (2020), 2013 bankruptcy \$18bn; for Gwynedd — 64.4% Welsh-speakers, 150% council-tax premium from 2023, 40%+ second homes in Abersoch; for Cardiff Bay — 1987–2000, 200-ha lagoon, 16,000 jobs. Rehearse these.

9a. Demographic Change and Places

Places change because their people change. Eduqas requires candidates to handle demographic transformation as both an endogenous adjustment (ageing, youth out-migration) and an exogenous pressure (international migration, retirement inflow, student influx).

Age Structure

Coastal and rural Welsh places are ageing faster than the UK average. Powys, Ceredigion, Conwy and the Isle of Anglesey all have more than 25% of population aged 65+ (2021 Census), compared with 18.6% for England and Wales overall. An ageing structure changes service demand (more health and social care, fewer schools), the labour market, and the political complexion of the place. In contrast inner-London boroughs such as Tower Hamlets and Newham remain young (median age below 32).

Ethnicity and Diversity

The 2021 Census recorded the highest ever share of people in England and Wales identifying with an ethnic group other than White (18.3%). Ethnic diversity is highly place-specific: in London 46.2% of residents are from non-White ethnic groups; in Wales as a whole 6.2%; Blaenau Gwent is around 98% White. Placing regeneration and gentrification debates against ethnic composition exposes who tends to be displaced: in Tower Hamlets, Hackney and Lambeth the original working-class communities often included substantial Bangladeshi, Caribbean and African populations.

Migration

Three migration streams reshape UK places: international immigration (annual net migration peaked at over 900,000 in 2023 on revised ONS estimates, then fell to ~204,000 in the year ending June 2025), internal migration from cities to smaller settlements (accelerated 2020–22 by Covid-19 home-working), and retirement/lifestyle migration into coastal and rural communities. Each stream has a differential place footprint: international migration strengthens already-diverse urban nodes; internal migration shifts demand from cities to their hinterlands and beyond; retirement migration ages coastal demographics and raises coastal property values.

Flow	Dominant destination type	Key place effects	Example
International immigration	Global cities, regional capitals	Diversity up, language shift, housing pressure	Leicester (2021 Census majority-minority)

Internal counter-urbanisation	Towns, rural commuter villages	House prices up, age rises, car dependency	Rural Powys, Devon
Retirement / lifestyle	Coastal & scenic areas	Ageing, seasonal economy, second homes	Abersoch, North Norfolk
Student migration	University cities	HMO pressure, seasonal population, night-time economy	Cardiff's Cathays; Manchester Fallowfield
Return / diaspora	Historic home place	Remittances, transnational identity	Polish return migration post-2016

Exam tip — tie demographic change to place character: Do not list census percentages in isolation. Link each number to a place-character consequence ("Powys's 27% aged 65+ fuels demand for domiciliary care and restricts young-labour supply"). This crosses the AO1/AO2 boundary examiners look for.

10. Evaluating Regeneration and Rebranding

Evaluation is the explicit AO3 skill tested in extended Eduqas responses. Candidates must ask not simply "did regeneration succeed?" but "for whom, on what timescale, measured against which criteria, and who controlled the narrative?" A useful three-axis framework:

1. **Distributional (winners and losers)** — who gained jobs, housing, services, status; who was displaced, marginalised or made invisible. Gentrification's classic indictment is that its benefits and costs fall on different groups.
2. **Temporal** — short-term construction boosts vs. long-term liveability; flagship completion vs. 20-year operation; the gap between ribbon-cutting and meaningful community outcomes.
3. **Governance** — statutory top-down (UDCs) vs. community-led (Community Land Trusts, Assets of Community Value); outsider-imposed vs. insider-authored narratives.

Sustainability analysis (environmental, economic, social) is also explicit in the Eduqas mark scheme. Cardiff Bay Barrage is the single most-cited UK case illustrating that economic-sustainability gains (tourism, flagship buildings) can be purchased at environmental-sustainability cost (SSSI mudflat loss).

Exam tip — structuring 15-mark place evaluations: A reliable structure: (i) define key terms including place, regeneration/rebranding; (ii) establish the place with 2–3 quantified facts; (iii) evaluate through winners, losers and sustainability, each with evidence; (iv) contrast with a second place at a different scale; (v) conclude with a judgement that engages with “to what extent”. Do not write a single-case narrative essay.

Statutory vs Community-led Regeneration

A central evaluative axis for Eduqas is the governance of regeneration: top-down statutory schemes vs bottom-up community-led schemes. Each generates a distinct mix of winners, losers and narratives.

Dimension	Statutory / top-down	Community-led
Agent	Central state, UDC, regional dev't body	Community trusts, co-ops, parish/community councils
Funding	Treasury, EU structural funds (pre-2020), levelling-up grants	Heritage Lottery, Community Asset Transfer, Community Share Issue
Scale	Large (district to region)	Small (neighbourhood to village)
Speed	Rapid once approved	Slow, iterative
Legitimacy challenge	Risk of outsider-imposed narrative	Risk of limited reach, capture by loudest voices
Example	LDDC; Cardiff Bay Development Corp; Levelling Up Fund Round 1	Hastings Pier Charity; Ynni Ogwen community renewables (Gwynedd)

Contemporary UK policy has drifted from purely top-down (1980s UDCs) toward mixed forms: Community Infrastructure Levy, Neighbourhood Planning (England, Localism Act 2011), Community Asset Transfer, and Welsh Government's Transforming Towns programme require partnership between local authority and community. Still, the capital scale of flagship regeneration overwhelmingly remains state- or private-capital led.

Exam tip — use the governance axis for evaluation: A 15-mark “assess the success of regeneration” answer benefits enormously from comparing a top-down flagship (Canary Wharf) with a community-led scheme (e.g. the Ynni Ogwen community hydro scheme, Gwynedd). The contrast surfaces the distributional question: success for whom, authored by whom?

11. Methodologies for Studying Place

Eduqas fieldwork and NEA-type skills require candidates to know the mixed-method toolkit for studying place. Quantitative and qualitative approaches are complementary: one without the other is usually inadequate.

Quantitative Methods

- **UK Census** — England/Wales decennial (2021 most recent); Scotland 2022. Provides age, ethnicity, employment, language, housing tenure, health. Free, granular (LSOA/Output Area level), comparable.
- **ONS Sub-national indicators** — annual population estimates, migration flows, labour market.
- **Indices of Multiple Deprivation** — WIMD 2019 (Wales), IMD 2019 (England); composite scores combining income, employment, health, education, access, housing, community safety.
- **House-price and land-registry data** — tracks affordability and displacement pressure.
- **Environmental monitoring** — air quality (Welsh Air Quality Forum), water quality, SSSI condition.

Qualitative Methods

- **Semi-structured interviews** — capture insider voice and nuance; weakness is small sample and reflexivity demands.
- **Oral history** — longitudinal depth; often through archives (e.g. St Fagans National Museum of History).
- **Place-mapping & mental maps** — residents sketch perceived boundaries, valued features and negative nodes; reveals insider cognition.
- **Photo-elicitation** — interview subjects discuss photographs (their own or supplied); surfaces sensory and emotional dimensions.
- **Ethnography** — sustained immersion; strongest at revealing practice (the third Low & Altman component).

- **Content analysis of representations** — systematic coding of media, brochures, novels, social media posts.

Participatory Methods

- **Community consultation** — statutory under the Planning (Wales) Act 2015 and the Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015, which obliges Welsh public bodies to apply a “sustainable development principle” including long-term, prevention, integration, collaboration and involvement.
- **Citizen science / participatory GIS** — residents capture data on local issues (litter mapping, cultural-asset mapping).
- **Place-based well-being assessment** — the Welsh Government's National Well-being Indicators include community cohesion and cultural participation as place-relevant metrics.

Exam tip — always pair quantitative with qualitative: Methodology questions are routinely lost by candidates who default to the census alone. Pair one quantitative source (census, WIMD) with one qualitative source (interview, photo-elicitation) and specify what each reveals that the other misses. A census tells you Gwynedd has 64.4% Welsh-speakers; only an interview tells you why a particular household switched to English in the 2010s.

12. Welsh Context (Useful Contrasting Places)

Eduqas A110QS is the WJEC Eduqas A-level regulated by Ofqual for England (students in Wales take the WJEC A-level); Welsh places are valid case studies but the specification does not weight Welsh context more heavily — your own home place must be studied first. Welsh examples are, however, excellent contrasting places, and these frames are useful when you use them:

- **Bilingual heritage** — the Welsh Language Measure 2011 made Welsh an official language of Wales and established the Welsh Language Commissioner; Welsh Government's *Cymraeg 2050* strategy targets one million Welsh-speakers by 2050.
- **Devolved governance** — the Senedd (since 1999, renamed Senedd Cymru in 2020) has competence over planning, housing, local government, economic regeneration and culture; UK government controls macroeconomic levers. This creates a distinctive two-tier place-shaping context.
- **Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015** — places seven well-being goals (including “a Wales of cohesive communities” and “a Wales of vibrant culture and thriving Welsh language”) at the

centre of public-body duties. The Act reframes place-making as an intergenerational sustainability obligation.

- **Planning (Wales) Act 2015** — introduces the National Development Framework (*Future Wales: The National Plan 2040*, published 2021), integrating place-based planning across scales.
- **Indigenous place identity** — Bannau Brycheiniog (2023), Eryri preferred over “Snowdonia”, Welsh-first signage policies; these materially change how places are represented and understood.

Mini-case: The Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 in place-making:

The Act places a duty on over 40 named Welsh public bodies to act in accordance with the sustainable-development principle and pursue seven well-being goals. The Future Generations Commissioner for Wales publishes a five-yearly report assessing performance. For Changing Places, the Act is a useful evaluative hook: when assessing Cardiff Bay regeneration, Gwynedd rural policy, or any Welsh place response, candidates can reference the Act's statutory framing — a feature absent in English regeneration case studies. It gives a ready-made set of criteria for evaluation.

Exam tip — use the Well-being Act when you write about a Welsh place: Naming the Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 and linking a specific goal (e.g. “a Wales of cohesive communities”) to a case-study outcome hits both AO1 (specification recall) and AO3 (evaluation against stated criteria). It gives your evaluation clear, stated criteria.

12a. Depth Dive — Cardiff Bay Barrage Environmental Trade-off

The Cardiff Bay Barrage is the single most-examined environmental-sustainability case in the Eduqas specification because it forces candidates to weigh economic regeneration against ecological loss with hard numbers.

The Engineering

The barrage, completed November 1999, is a 1.1 km structure across the mouths of the Rivers Taff and Ely with five sluice gates, three locks for shipping and a fish pass. It impounds a 200-hectare freshwater lagoon with a perimeter of ~13 km. The scheme was authorised by the Cardiff Bay Barrage Act 1993 and cost ~£220 million (1999 prices).

The Environmental Loss

Before impoundment the estuary supported 250 hectares of intertidal mudflat designated as a Site of Special Scientific Interest (SSSI) for its wader populations. Peak winter counts included ~6,500 dunlin, ~1,200 redshank and significant curlew. The RSPB and other conservation bodies campaigned against the scheme; in mitigation, the Newport Wetlands Reserve (opened 2000) was created further along the Severn Estuary.

The Regeneration Gain

Against the ecological loss, CBDC claimed: 26,000 jobs created or safeguarded (revised downward by independent auditors to ~16,000), £1.8 billion private investment leveraged against £500 million public, 6,000 new homes, a new parliamentary home for Welsh devolution, and an attraction generating over 4 million visitors a year by the 2010s.

Why It Matters for Evaluation

The barrage case is a gift to examiners because (a) both sides are quantified; (b) it pits three of the seven Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 goals against each other ("a prosperous Wales" vs "a resilient Wales" vs "a Wales of vibrant culture"); (c) it has a clear insider/outsider split (Butetown residents; national civic pride; ornithologists); and (d) 25 years on, outcome data allow retrospective judgement, not just prospective argument.

Exam tip — use Cardiff Bay Barrage for sustainability evaluation: When a question prompts sustainability judgement, the barrage lets you score in all three pillars simultaneously: economic (£1.8bn leveraged, 16,000 jobs), social (Senedd, civic identity, displaced Butetown), environmental (SSSI loss, Newport Wetlands mitigation). A single case delivers triangulated evaluation.

12b. Depth Dive — Post-Industrial Welsh Valleys

Deindustrialisation in the South Wales Valleys offers a parallel Welsh case to Detroit at smaller scale. From peak Welsh coal production of 57 million tonnes in 1913 (with employment peaking at ~271,000 men in 1920), the industry contracted catastrophically through the 20th century: the 1984–85 miners' strike, pit closures under British Coal (1988 Six Bells, 1989 Merthyr Vale at Aberfan and Marine Colliery; Tower Colliery, closed by British Coal in 1994, was bought by its workers and reopened in 1995 as the UK's only worker-owned deep mine, finally closing 2008).

Valley towns such as **Merthyr Tydfil**, **Rhondda**, **Blaenau Gwent** and **Caerphilly** experienced: sustained unemployment (Merthyr Tydfil unemployment peaked above 25% in the early 1990s), out-migration of young adults, above-average health deprivation (life expectancy in Blaenau Gwent was 77.3 years for men in 2018–20, compared with 83.9 in Buckinghamshire), and negative place image reinforced by media portrayals.

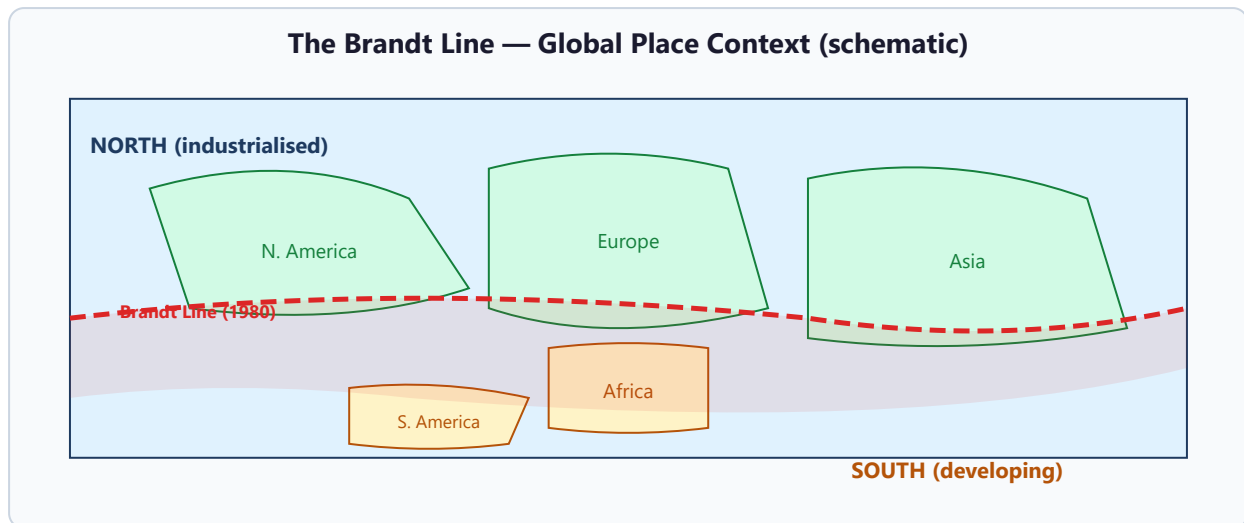
Regeneration responses:

- **European Structural Funds** (pre-2020): West Wales and the Valleys designated a “less developed region” eligible for Objective 1 funding (2000–06) and Convergence funding (2007–13, 2014–20). Approximately £4 billion of EU investment flowed into infrastructure, skills and business support.
- **Welsh Government Valleys Taskforce** (2016–21): delivered projects including the Dare Valley Country Park expansion, the Tech Valleys programme (Ebbw Vale) and the Valleys Regional Park.
- **Big Pit National Coal Museum** (Blaenavon): heritage-led rebranding converting former pit into UNESCO World Heritage Site (2000), drawing ~150,000 visitors annually.
- **Shared Prosperity Fund** (UK Government, 2022 onwards): replaces EU funding at approximately equivalent scale, but administered differently and contested by Welsh Government as reducing devolved autonomy.

Outcomes are mixed: employment has recovered from 1990s lows but remains heavily in lower-paid services; health inequalities persist; the population of the former coalfield declined ~10% between 1991 and 2021 while Cardiff-Newport grew ~25%. The Valleys remain a canonical Eduqas example of the limits of regeneration at regional scale.

13. Global and Structural Context — The Brandt Line

Individual place changes sit within a global structural pattern. The **Brandt Line** (Willy Brandt, *North-South: A Programme for Survival*, 1980) proposed a rough division between the industrial, high-income “Global North” and the lower-income, historically colonised “Global South”, drawn approximately at 30°N (dipping to include Australia and New Zealand). Although widely criticised as simplistic and increasingly outdated — China, South Korea, the UAE and others have transformed their position — the line remains a starting reference for placing UK regeneration debates in a world of vast and uneven development. Detroit, Cardiff Bay and London Docklands are all “Northern” place-change stories; the drivers of their change (container-shipping, globalisation, deindustrialisation) are intrinsically trans-regional.



Exam tip — use the Brandt Line as scaffolding, not doctrine: Referencing Brandt signals awareness of global structure but must be paired with a critique (“NICs such as South Korea have crossed the line; intra-regional inequality is now larger than inter-regional in some metrics”). Examiners penalise uncritical deployment of the 1980 model as current truth.

13a. Place Identity and Political Geography

Place identity has become politically salient in 21st-century UK politics in ways that Eduqas candidates should be able to reference. The 2016 EU referendum exposed sharp place-based divergence: deindustrialised coastal and small-town constituencies voted decisively Leave while cosmopolitan city centres and university towns voted Remain. Geographers including Danny Dorling and Will Jennings framed this as “two Englands” — or more precisely a spectrum of place-trajectories in which some places felt “left behind” by globalisation while others felt propelled by it. The subsequent political vocabulary (“levelling up”, “red wall”, “blue wall”) is explicitly place-based.

In Wales the politics are distinct: the 2021 Senedd election and the Plaid Cymru / Welsh Labour Cooperation Agreement 2021–24 placed place-specific policy (second-home regulation, Welsh language continuity, transport devolution) at the centre of governance. The December 2022 independent Commission on the Constitutional Future of Wales demonstrates that place identity and governance remain an active site of political contest.

Left behind places: A term used in UK policy and academic literature since c. 2016 to describe settlements, frequently former industrial or coastal towns, that have experienced relative decline in

income, services, demographic health and political voice compared with metropolitan centres. Central to the Levelling Up framework and contested for its implicit passivity in framing residents as objects rather than agents.

13b. Case Studies at a Glance — Additional Examples

The four anchor case studies above should be complemented by a wider stock of named examples that Eduqas candidates can deploy as short evidence points.

Place	Process	Key fact
Hackney Wick, London	Olympics-driven regeneration + gentrification	2012 Olympics delivered £9bn investment; sharp rent rises and displacement of artists' studios in Hackney Wick and Fish Island
Hull	Rebranding via culture	UK City of Culture 2017; 95% of residents attended 1+ cultural event
Liverpool waterfront	Regeneration + UNESCO WHS delisting	WHS status awarded 2004, delisted 2021 over Peel L&P waterside development
Salford Quays / MediaCity	Regeneration + BBC relocation	BBC North opened 2011; ~8,000 people now work at MediaCityUK
Totnes, Devon	Transition Towns counter-movement	Founded 2006 by Rob Hopkins; now 1,000+ Transition initiatives globally
Newtown, Powys	Welsh-language market town regeneration	Transforming Towns funding 2020–; bilingual retail signage policy
Stoke-on-Trent	Post-industrial ceramics, Levelling Up	£56m LUF award 2021 for Etruscan Square + Goods Yard
Dharavi, Mumbai	Informal settlement regeneration	~1m residents in 2.1 km ² ; Adani redevelopment plan 2023

Exam tip — cultivate a stock of “short evidence” places: Alongside the four anchor case studies, memorise one-line facts about six to eight additional places drawn from the table above. In a 15-mark answer these act as comparators and signal breadth. One quantified fact per place is enough.

14. Synthesis — What a Top-Band Changing Places Answer Looks Like

Pulling the specification together, an A* Eduqas Changing Places answer typically exhibits:

- A clear definition of place as location + locale + sense of place (Agnew) with Massey's progressive sense of place cited.
- A weighed combination of endogenous and exogenous factors, with the exogenous privileged for contemporary change.
- At least two named places compared at different scales, at least one Welsh, with 3–4 quantified facts each.
- A distinction between regeneration and rebranding and which predominates.
- Discussion of winners and losers, insider vs outsider narratives, and contested representations.
- Explicit reference to the Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 or the Welsh Language Measure 2011 where Welsh context is relevant.
- A judgement tied to the question stem, not a restatement of the introduction.

Revision Checklist

- Can you define and apply *place*, *sense of place*, *placelessness*, *progressive sense of place*, *glocalisation*, *clone town*, *gentrification*, *regeneration*, *rebranding*, *place attachment*?
- Can you distinguish endogenous vs exogenous factors for a named place?
- Can you argue both sides of the London Docklands legacy with quantified evidence?
- Can you explain the Gwynedd second-home policy with the 150% council-tax premium and three linked policy tools?
- Can you draw the gentrification cycle and place-making feedback loop from memory?
- Can you reference the Well-being of Future Generations (Wales) Act 2015 goals in a Welsh place case?

- Can you pair a quantitative source (census, WIMD) with a qualitative source (interview, novel) in a methodology answer?
- Can you contrast a UK case (Cardiff Bay) with an international case (Detroit) on governance, scale and outcomes?

Exam tip — use active verbs for place processes: Place questions reward precise process language. “Capital flows into the rent gap, developers acquire undervalued stock, rents rise, original tenants are displaced” is stronger than “the area gets gentrified.” Examiner reports cite vague processual language as a leading cause of mid-band capping.

Exam tip — always close with judgement: Eduqas “to what extent” and “assess” prompts require a judgement sentence that commits. “On balance the LDDC succeeded as economic regeneration but failed as community regeneration” beats “there are arguments on both sides.” Neutrality is not the same as evaluation.

15. Deeper Theory — Place-Making, Power and Representation

Top-band candidates can show awareness of the theoretical lineage behind the specification. Four strands are particularly rewarded.

Massey's Progressive Sense of Place (1991, 1994)

Doreen Massey's essay “A Global Sense of Place” (*Marxism Today*, June 1991) argued that place identity cannot be defensively drawn around supposed authentic local traits, because all places are produced through relations that extend beyond their boundaries. Kilburn High Road — Massey's example — is simultaneously Irish, Indian, Islamic, English, working class, cosmopolitan. Her *progressive sense of place* embraces this relational openness rather than retreating into a defensive “ours vs theirs” narrative. For Eduqas, this concept is ideal for evaluating contested places (Butetown/Cardiff Bay; Llŷn/Abersoch): it enables candidates to argue that neither the insider nor the outsider narrative is solely authentic.

Harvey's Time-Space Compression (1989)

David Harvey (*The Condition of Postmodernity*, 1989) described the shrinking of experienced distance under late capitalism: containerisation, jet travel, fibre-optic cable and now 5G each compress the time and

relative cost of moving people, goods, capital and information. The resulting acceleration homogenises some places (clone-town retail; airport-hotel landscapes) while fracturing others (gentrified islands within left-behind cities). Candidates can use Harvey to explain why the same exogenous forces yield both Canary Wharf's global connectivity and Merthyr Tydfil's relative isolation.

Relph's Placelessness (1976)

Edward Relph (*Place and Placelessness*, 1976) introduced **placelessness** as a diagnosis of 20th-century landscape change: the proliferation of interchangeable motorway services, retail parks and corporate architecture that could be anywhere, evacuating place of distinctive meaning. The concept underpins contemporary concerns about “clone towns” and international chain-led streetscapes.

Lefebvre's Production of Space (1974)

Henri Lefebvre distinguished *perceived space* (everyday material practice), *conceived space* (planners' and architects' representations) and *lived space* (inhabitants' symbolic and imaginative use). Conflict arises when conceived space (e.g. LDDC masterplan, Cardiff Bay CBDC plan) overrides lived space (East End community memory; Butetown Tiger Bay). This trialectic gives Eduqas candidates a sophisticated framework for evaluating regeneration contestation.

Topophilia / Topophobia: Yi-Fu Tuan (1974) named the affective poles of place experience.

Topophilia is love of place — the warm feeling of belonging, memory, rootedness. *Topophobia* is its inverse — fear, alienation, rejection. Both are products of lived experience and representation; both shape how residents resist or embrace place change.

Exam tip — name at least one theorist per answer: Referencing Agnew, Massey, Harvey, Relph, Tuan or Lefebvre (with a sentence of application, not just a name-drop) signals AO1 depth and AO3 conceptual framing. One cited theorist is a reliable discriminator between Band 3 and Band 4.

16. Urban Morphology and Place Character

The physical fabric of a place encodes its historic political economy. A grounded understanding of **urban morphology** — the study of townscape elements and their formation — allows candidates to read a place from its built form.

Conzenian Townscape Analysis

M.R.G. Conzen's study of Alnwick (1960) established three elements of townscape:

- **The town plan** — streets, plots (burgage strips) and block pattern.
- **The building fabric** — the three-dimensional built form on those plots.
- **Land and building use** — the activities contained within the fabric.

The plan changes slowest (medieval burgage plots survive in many Welsh market towns including Newtown, Cowbridge and Caernarfon); the fabric changes on a 50–150 year cycle; use changes fastest. When regeneration preserves plan and fabric but changes use (a chapel to a flat; a warehouse to a gallery) the character of the place is partly retained; when plan is wiped (comprehensive clearance as at pre-1999 Cardiff Bay) the change is far more radical.

Burgage Cycle and Fringe Belts

Conzen described the *burgage cycle*: slow infill of rear gardens from 18th-century open plots through 19th-century workshop sheds to 20th-century comprehensive redevelopment, and the *fringe belt* — a ring of lower-density, institutional or open land (cemeteries, hospitals, allotments) fossilising former settlement edges. Both concepts appear in questions asking why some streets feel “old” and others “new”, even within a single town.

Urban morphology: The study of the form, structure and evolution of settlements as a product of plan, fabric and use. Central to the Conzenian tradition and foundational for heritage-led regeneration policy.

17. Digital Place — Algorithmic Representation

Place representation in the 2020s is increasingly mediated by digital platforms: Google Maps, Instagram, Airbnb, TikTok and local review sites all produce *algorithmic* place images that function alongside traditional media. Candidates who can reference this earn AO2 credit for contemporary application.

- **Instagram / TikTok tourism** — honeypot effects (Portmeirion, Eryri summit queues, the Fairy Pools on Skye) driven by viral imagery. Local authorities including Gwynedd and Eryri National Park Authority have issued crowd-management guidance and, in some cases, pre-booking systems.

- **Airbnb density** — distorts housing markets in small Welsh coastal settlements. Inside Airbnb data for Abersoch shows active listings per capita far above London averages.
- **Google StreetView** — functions as an ambient outsider-gaze archive; candidates can reference the difference between the 2009 and 2023 StreetView imagery of a given street to evidence gentrification.
- **Reddit / Nextdoor / Facebook local groups** — host vernacular (often contested) insider discourse about place change.

Algorithmic place: The representation of place generated, curated and amplified by platform algorithms that rank and recommend content according to engagement metrics rather than editorial judgement. Tends to privilege visually striking or controversial place images over everyday ones, producing distinctive distortions of outsider perception.

Exam tip — cite a digital example once per paper: Candidates who reference Instagram or Airbnb alongside traditional media representation signal currency to examiners. One example, briefly linked to process (e.g. “viral Instagram imagery concentrates footfall at Eryri's Llyn Idwal, adding to pressure that led to pre-booked parking at Pen-y-Pass”), is sufficient.

18. Worked Exam Questions

Three sample Eduqas-style prompts with plan-level answers.

Q1 (15 marks) — “Assess the view that exogenous factors are the primary drivers of place change in the contemporary UK.”

- **Intro:** Define place (Agnew); define endogenous vs exogenous; signal argument (exogenous dominant but mediated by endogenous response).
- **P1 (exogenous):** Globalisation, containerisation, migration. London Docklands as a place shaped overwhelmingly by exogenous forces (container-shipping decline, global finance, LDDC capital). Quantified evidence.
- **P2 (exogenous):** Airbnb, media imagery, counter-urbanisation. Gwynedd villages. 40% second homes in Abersoch; Welsh language retreat.
- **P3 (endogenous counterweight):** Welsh Language Measure 2011, Gwynedd Council 150% premium, Well-being of Future Generations Act 2015. Local agency still shapes outcomes.

- **P4 (nuance):** Interaction. Massey's progressive sense of place. Exogenous drivers set the stage; endogenous responses determine whether a place becomes a clone town or a distinctive adaptation.
- **Judgement:** Exogenous forces are the primary drivers of change but not of character; endogenous mediation determines which changes stick.

Q2 (15 marks) — “To what extent has flagship regeneration succeeded in Cardiff Bay?”

- **Intro:** Define regeneration and rebranding; name CBDC 1987–2000 and £2.4bn investment; signal mixed judgement.
- **P1 (success):** 16,000 jobs, Senedd, Wales Millennium Centre, 4m+ visitors, civic identity.
- **P2 (failure):** Tiger Bay displacement; barrage environmental loss (SSSI, ~6,500 dunlin); affordability.
- **P3 (evaluation):** Well-being of Future Generations Act lens: “a prosperous Wales” achieved; “a resilient Wales” compromised; “a Wales of vibrant culture” partly achieved but community-lived culture eroded.
- **Judgement:** Flagship regeneration succeeded on economic and iconic metrics but the social balance sheet remains negative for the original community.

Q3 (8 marks) — “Explain how insider and outsider perspectives may differ for a named place you have studied.”

- Choose Gwynedd villages / Abersoch.
- Insider: Welsh-speaking, intergenerational, school, chapel, year-round economy; experiences second-home pressure as displacement.
- Outsider: summer resident, English-speaking, sees village as “escape”, experiences it as peaceful and picturesque; sense of entitlement to property investment.
- Mediation: media coverage, Airbnb listings, Cymdeithas yr Iaith campaigns, council-tax policy.
- Link to Massey: both narratives partial; progressive sense of place requires recognising mutual interdependence.

Exam tip — plan before writing: Even 2 minutes spent on a four-paragraph skeleton raises marks. Examiner reports consistently flag structure as the single largest cause of Band-3 caps for candidates with adequate content.

19. Glossary — Rapid Recall

Term	One-line definition
Place	Location + locale + sense of place (Agnew)
Locale	Material setting for everyday social relations
Sense of place	Subjective emotional attachment to place
Topophilia / Topophobia	Love / fear of place (Tuan)
Endogenous	Internal place-shaping factors
Exogenous	External place-shaping factors
Glocalisation	Distinctive local responses to global forces
Placelessness	Loss of distinctive place character (Relph)
Clone town	Homogenised chain-dominated high street
Gentrification	Capital-led displacement of lower-income residents
Counter-urbanisation	Urban-to-rural population movement
Re-urbanisation	Population and investment return to city centres
Regeneration	Co-ordinated physical, economic and social renewal
Rebranding	Intentional identity/image campaign for a place
Place attachment	Bond of affect, cognition and practice (Low & Altman)
Progressive sense of place	Relational, outward-looking place identity (Massey)
Time-space compression	Shrinking experienced distance under late capitalism (Harvey)
Left-behind place	Settlement in relative decline vs metropolitan centres

19a. Extended Rural Place Change — Theory and UK Applications

Rural place change deserves dedicated theoretical treatment because Eduqas candidates too often default to urban examples. The rural is neither static nor residual; it is actively produced and contested.

The Rural Idyll vs the Contested Countryside

The *rural idyll* is the dominant outsider representation of the UK countryside — green, peaceful, rooted, nostalgic, white, middle-class. It is produced by heritage advertising, period drama (Downton Abbey, Poldark), property magazines (Country Life) and estate-agent marketing. The *contested countryside* literature (Paul Cloke, Michael Woods) shows how this idyll systematically occludes rural poverty, agricultural precarity, migrant labour, ethnic diversity, housing displacement and mental-health crises. Welsh rural case studies (Gwynedd, Powys, Ceredigion) expose the gap between idyll and reality especially sharply because linguistic and cultural distinctness are additionally at stake.

Cloke's Rural Index and the Cultural Turn

Paul Cloke's *index of rurality* (1977, revised 1986) used variables such as population density, commuting distance and occupational structure to classify UK rural areas; by the 1990s he had shifted to a *cultural* approach arguing that "rural" is defined as much by representation and symbolic practice as by statistics. This cultural turn underpins the Eduqas treatment of place as meaning-laden rather than purely measurable.

Key Drivers of UK Rural Change

- **Agricultural restructuring** — post-2020 Basic Payment Scheme replaced by Environmental Land Management (ELM) in England and the Sustainable Farming Scheme (delayed to 2026) in Wales. Shifts subsidies from production to public goods (carbon, biodiversity, access).
- **Rural gentrification** — counter-urbanising professionals outbid local wages; Hay-on-Wye, Tetbury, Ludlow are canonical English examples; Crickhowell and Narberth are Welsh parallels.
- **Second homes and short-lets** — most acute on the Welsh coast (Gwynedd, Ceredigion, Pembrokeshire) and in Cornwall (St Ives introduced a residents-only housing policy 2016).
- **Service rationalisation** — rural bank branch closures, sub-post-office retreat, school amalgamation. Many small rural primary schools in Wales have closed or merged since the 2000s.
- **Remote work** — the 2020–2022 shift to home-working accelerated counter-urbanisation; ONS data show net out-migration from London to rural LAs peaked in 2021 before partial reversal.

- **Re-wilding and landscape change** — Knepp Estate (W. Sussex), Cambrian Wildwood at Bwlch Corog (near Machynlleth). Contested where it displaces upland farming.

Mini-case: St Ives, Cornwall — a residents-only housing policy:

In May 2016 St Ives residents voted 83% in favour of a Neighbourhood Development Plan banning the sale of new-build homes as second homes — the first UK planning policy of its kind, upheld on appeal in the High Court in November 2016. Evidence for Eduqas: demonstrates endogenous policy agency at the smallest scale, the legitimacy of community-led planning, and the transferability of restrictive residency policy to Welsh cases (Gwynedd, Pembrokeshire). Research since suggests the policy cut new-build construction and pushed second-home demand into existing homes, so its net effect on affordability is debated.

Mini-case: Hebden Bridge, West Yorkshire — rural rebranding:

Former mill town (textiles peaked pre-WW2, collapsed by 1970s) rebranded from the 1980s as a bohemian enclave: independent shops, LGBT+ population, arts festivals, “fourth-funkiest town in the world” (British Airways magazine, 2005). 2012 and 2015 Calder floods exposed the vulnerability of the narrow valley. The “Slow the Flow” upstream moorland peatland-restoration scheme (2015–) demonstrates endogenous place-scale adaptation. Useful UK-England rural-change case to pair with Welsh examples.

19b. Advanced Evaluation — Three Frames for Regeneration Judgement

Strong evaluation requires named frames. Three are especially transferable:

Frame 1 — The Triple Bottom Line

Economic, social, and environmental outcomes. A regeneration that delivers jobs (economic) but displaces community (social) and damages habitat (environmental) is only one-third successful. Cardiff Bay scores strongly on economic, modestly on social, weakly on environmental. London Docklands scores strongly on economic, weakly on social, moderately on environmental.

Frame 2 — Winners and Losers Matrix

Identify stakeholders explicitly. For each case, list at least three winners and three losers, with a quantified fact where possible. This answers “for whom?” — a question the examiner rewards but candidates often overlook.

Stakeholder category	London Docklands example	Gwynedd example
Capital / developers	Olympia & York, Brookfield, major UK banks	Holiday-let agencies, retirement-home buyers
National state	Thatcher government (UDC model legitimised)	UK Treasury (capital gains on second-home sales)
Devolved / local state	Tower Hamlets (by-passed)	Gwynedd Council (activist via premium)
Incoming residents	Financial professionals, expats	English retirees, weekend owners
Original residents	Displaced East Enders, Bangladeshi community	Welsh-speaking young adults priced out
Environment	Habitat fragmentation, air quality	Coastal erosion accelerated by demand; AONB pressure

Frame 3 — Sustainability over Time

Regeneration outcomes must be judged across decades, not years. LDDC's 1990 claims look different after the 2008 crash; Detroit's 2017 downtown revival looks different after the 2020–21 pandemic. Candidates who build time-horizon awareness into evaluation (“initial vs sustained effects”) earn AO3 credit.

Exam tip — frame the evaluation, then do it: Open your evaluation paragraph with a named frame (“Assessed against the triple bottom line,...”) before applying it. This signals methodological awareness to the examiner and produces tighter argument.

20. Final Consolidation

Changing Places is the most conceptually demanding of the Eduqas Component 1 options: it asks candidates to weave definitional rigour, theoretical awareness, quantified case-study recall and evaluative judgement. The examiner rewards answers that (i) treat place as a *process* rather than a static location, (ii) triangulate endogenous and exogenous drivers, (iii) deploy their home place and at least one contrasting place in quantified detail alongside a contrasting international case, (iv) acknowledge contested insider/outsider narratives, and (v) land a judgement tied to the question stem. The four anchor case studies — London Docklands, Gwynedd second-home villages, Cardiff Bay and Detroit — between them cover every standard Eduqas prompt. Layered onto these, the theorists (Agnew, Massey, Harvey, Relph, Tuan, Lefebvre) and the Welsh statutory context (Well-being of Future Generations Act 2015, Welsh Language Measure 2011, Planning (Wales) Act 2015) provide the conceptual and institutional scaffolding for top-band answers.

Exam tip — one last reminder: The most common examiner comment on mid-band Changing Places answers is “over-described, under-evaluated”. Every paragraph should explicitly serve the question's command word, not merely describe a place. If a sentence could be cut without weakening the argument, cut it.